



“You have to think about the unintended consequences and the biases. I would advise start-ups to have broader and powerful data sets, do a lot of testing, and run a lot of pilots”

SHANTANU NARAYEN
CHAIRMAN & CEO,
ADOBE



“We integrated Explainable and Ethical AI into our AI. This ensures that the data set is unbiased by picking up a reasonable sample of the data after considering aspects like geographies, culture, etc.”

MONISH DARDA
CO-FOUNDER,
ICERTIS



“Sometimes, early-stage start-ups don’t pay the highest heed to compliance because they have so much to do. Any omission in using AI sensibly may come back to bite them later”

SRINIVAS RAO MAHANKALI
CEO, T-HUB



“Awareness is one of the key pillars. We need people who understand RAI. Start-ups should try to understand the biases in data so well that they start creating their own data sets at the source level”

ANKIT BOSE
HEAD OF
AI, NASSCOM

AI, it is critical to continually ask questions, engage experts—such as software developers, data scientists, legal experts, the founders, etc.—and progress together,” says a Google spokesperson.

“Awareness is one of the biggest pillars. We need people who understand RAI,” says Bose, adding, when people understand RAI, they will be able to identify the ways in which AI models can interpret data in the same way as humans, and develop resources that can reverse-engineer issues when they arise.

IT'S NOT MAGIC

Icertis' Darda says that RAI is not magic, nor is it a destination. The need for a company to implement AI responsibly is a continuous one, he asserts, adding that it will take around 10–15 years to crack RAI. “But we will come closer to figuring out how to remove biases,” he says. From his own experience, Darda echoes T-Hub CEO Rao's point when he says that sometimes entrepreneurs are so excited about tech that they forget about the way they treat their data and algorithms. Thus, brushing aside the topic of RAI is not an option. Start-ups need to lead from the front because by not following the appropriate standards, they are putting users in peril.

Akbar Mohammed, Chief Data Scientist at data intelligence company Fractal Analytics, cites the

example of AI's use cases in mental healthcare as a word of caution. “Today we have AI that can detect if you have a mental health issue based on how you have conversations with your friends, what kind of news you browse, etc. And that intelligence can be used both to provide support if you need it, or be abused. Bad elements can use it to reduce your potential employability prospects in the market.”

So what is the way forward? “It's hard!” admits Shantanu Narayen, Chairman and CEO of software firm Adobe. Darda adds that thinking about RAI from the designing phase is something that will make or break a company. Responsible deployment of tech is as important as product market fit, customers, finance and more, he says. “You have to think about the unintended consequences and the biases that can emerge. I would advise start-ups to have broader and powerful data sets, do a lot of testing, and run a lot of pilots,” adds Narayen.

The bottom line that all the stakeholders agree on lies in intent and the purpose with which you build an AI model. And start-ups that are dealing with large processes, data and other information must get it right from the start. Even now, it is not too late. Why? Because it all starts with asking a simple question: am I implementing AI responsibly? **BT**

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